2 The previous military government set up the BGF to absorb the ceasefire ethnic armies into the command of the Tatmadaw. It resulted in the collapse of a seventeen-year ceasefire in April 2009 when armed groups refused to comply with orders to convert to the BGF.
3 Announcement No. 1/2011 by the Government of the Republic of the Union of Myanmar.
4 In 1963, General Ne Win made a similar announcement, initiating peace talks with ethnic insurgent groups. However, it was mainly for discussion of terms to surrender. See Min Zaw Oo (2014) and South (2013).
5 When the federal decision was made by NDSC, there seems to have been some disputes between Aung Min, his peace team, and the military generals. Internal sources confirmed that these were mainly related to promises made by Aung Min to ethnic groups at the peace discussions which the military found unacceptable. Therefore it appears that the mandate of Aung Min began to dissolve in the later days of the Thein Sein government.
6 Since the beginning of 2013, party leaders and lawmakers began to critique the opaque operational style of the government peace team supported by the MPC. The Speaker of the Lower House of Parliament, Thura Shwe Mann, raised concerns about the need for the parliamentarians to understand the ongoing peace process, and possibly prohibit concessions granted to the EAGs by Aung Min's executive power, and the UPWC's use of foreign grants in the peace project (see Burma News International 2014).
7 Under the executive branch, the Tatmadaw has authority over three security-related ministries, namely, defence, home affairs, and border affairs. The military also holds twenty-five per cent of seats in the union parliament and all regional and state parliaments. For discussion, see Chit Win, this volume.
8 Chapter XI of the 2008 Constitution allows the NDSC to impose martial law, disband parliament, and rule directly if a state of emergency is declared, and to exercise the powers of the legislature, executive, and judiciary before parliaments are formed.

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